



VertiGO!!!

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 708 June 2008 PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea and coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Paul Mason and some gentle foot work – West Ridge of Stargazer



Section Night 9 June 2008

Photo competition

Come and wow us and be wowed by this years fantastic photographic entries. Competition judged by Shaun Barnett. Shaun is well known for his outdoor photography and his award winning books.



Section Trip News

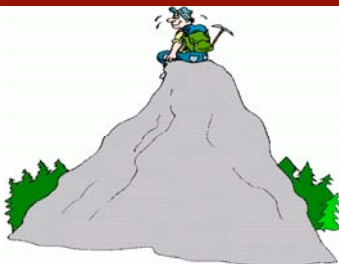
Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

BANMF Mountain Film Festival 2008 is here - 22nd June & 24th **- Showing at Paramount Theatre**



Once again, New Zealand Alpine Club are proud to be hosting the
2008 BANMF Mountain Film Festival.

TICKETS ON SALE AT NEXT SECTION NIGHT - 9TH JUNE '08
AND ALSO AT BIVOUAC



TRIP REPORTS



Summer 2008 by Don French

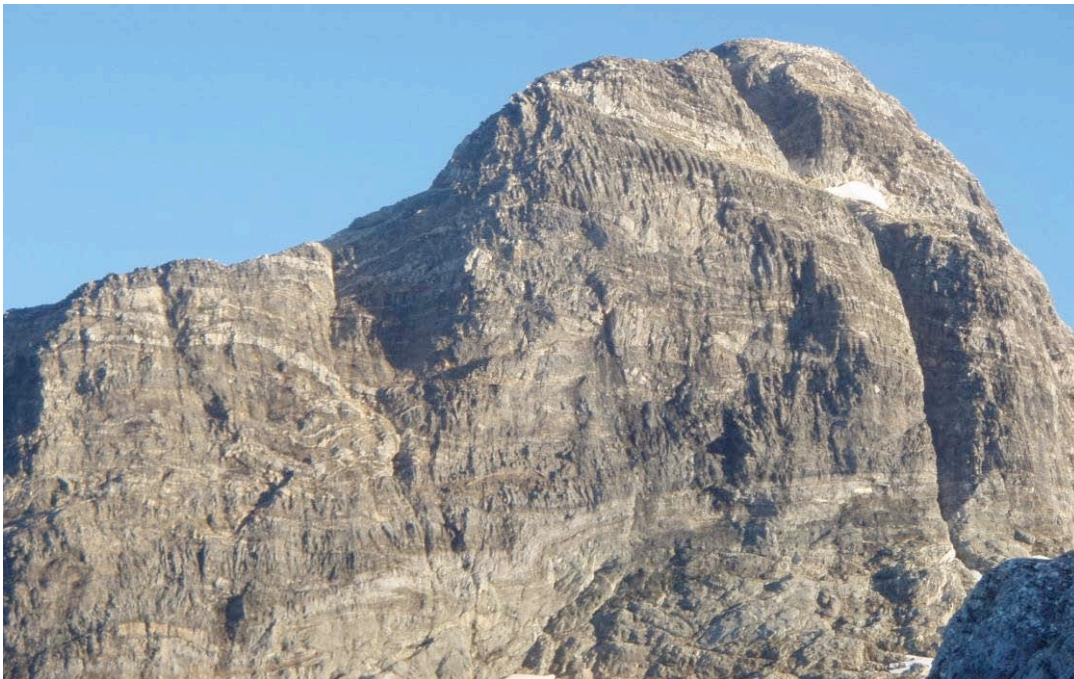
NIWA had promised the best summer weather for years, and so it was.

At MT Cook Ollie Touhy & Don French climbed Mt Hamilton from the rarely visited east ridge accessed via the Murchison valley. The lower ridge took a day to climb up. The rope was used to protect 3 or 4 pitches, with some very broken rock being experienced. They bivied at 2200ms. The second day of climbing was primary on ice and snow, following an appealing ridge which passed through a series of ice cliffs to the expansive summit snow fields. The descent was to the north and down the Darwin Glacier with a night being spent bivying on the Tasman glacier.

Paul Mason then joined Don French for a trip into the Olivine Ice Plateau. The route was from the Dart, and Seal col. 2 storm bound nights were spent camped at 2200ms just below the summit of Mt Watkins before a southerly clearing enables a hurried traverse of the Thunder Glacier onto the plateau, via Climax col. The route did require two rappels to pass a crevasse, but the efforts were rewarded with a spectacular camp on the plateau. The next morning Climax was dispatched in perfect conditions, and the two moved onto a night at the Olivine Ledge rock bivy, and then out via a ramble down the Beans Burn.

After celebrating a successful trip the same two then moved to Colin Todd hut, using a compass to navigate the white out of the Bonar glacier. The following day saw them climb the west ridge of Stargazer. The ridge was superb climb of moderate difficulty with spectacular views into the Waipara. Prior to exiting for a beer via Bevan col, Paul & Don climbed the full North West ridge of Aspiring.

Don spent some time at Homer hut before teaming up with Matt Downes, Paul & Trevor Bowker. Armed with a permit the 4 did a 4 day trip into the Murchison Mountains behind late Te Anua via the MacKenzie Burn. After a night at Robin Saddle hut the 4 climbed Mt Irene on yet another cloudless Fiordland day.



Irene from Robin Saddle



Ollie Touhy overcoming difficulties on East Ridge of Mt Hamilton



Paul Mason with another perfect camp, Olivine Ice Plateau

Don French



French Trip to Mt Murchison

Mt Murchison (2400m), Arthur's Pass National Park - ANZAC weekend 2008 – leader: Don "French Don" French

Well here we are three days after our return to civilization, and there are pterydactyls arranged in empty spaces all around our homes, their skeletal wings festooned with stinking piles of

technical fibres, rotting harnesses, slimy socks, decomposing boots, melting packs. Yes, it was a great weekend!, and Donatus Franciskus got us all there and back as planned.

The idea was mooted in the pages of *Fahrt und Go!*, the regular organ of the Wellington sect of the NZ Alpine Club, and over a dozen members rose to the challenge. The attractions were manifold: to conquer a big, bad South Island mountain, to mount the mount with the legendary Donni Frangipanni, to prove that survival on chocolate buttons and freeze-dried fish-pie was possible,

and that adults would submit to a regime of psychological pressure and extreme physical exertion amounting to torture, of their own free will. In fact this may have been a cruel socio-psychopathological experiment conducted by the Macciavellian agent of a certain DHB, Don Francisco di Master-Don.

His proposal, only revealed in full when the ferry had left berth and escape was no longer possible, was to sleep on the roadside near Rangiora when we could drive no more (four hours ziz only was permitted), to march 20km along the stony bed of the Waimakiriri River and ascend to Ronnie Barker Hut, to summit Murchison the next morning in a grim race against an advancing weather system, and then to dance across the massive and slippery rocks of the gorge (“just like a ballerina” to use El Don’s own words), finishing up, after a force-march back along the riverbed, in the club lodge at Arthur’s Pass for lukewarm showers and toughened steak.

The plan worked brilliantly, until on summit day we realized that the bad-weather system was being held up by the anticyclone over the area, and so the expected rains were delayed until departure day, leaving us with clear blue skies and amazing views over the White Glacier with its exquisite glass-blue crevasses large enough to drop a double-decker bus into and then throw another 3 buses on top.

A contest was held requiring summiteers to estimate how many tonnes of rock we would each cause to hurtle 80 metres down the summit couloir: on average at least 2 tonnes per person, we guessed. The noise alone was astounding, and the sense of danger deeply intimidating. The crumbling summit was linked to a false summit by a 3 metre á cheval ridge-section with a steep gravelly slope on one side and a vertical drop to the glacier on the other. None of us lingered here; indeed the present writer refused at this point, preferring to wonder if the true summit 3 metres above him was actually protected by tapu... an airy, frightening place was his impression, and this was near enough for him.

Several climbers felt the beautées of the White Glacier were sufficient compensation for the climb, and stayed below to enjoy the snows, the sun and the views north to the Waimakariri Gorge, where the keas screamed “Don... Don... aaarrgh!”

The victims were later identified as:

Michael Archer, Andrea Logan, Gavin Marshall, Paul Maxim, Kevin Patterson, Amanda Redvers, Simon Romanos, David Shanks, Jennifer Saunders, Matthew Scott, Gerard Smith, Matthew Stevens, James Wright, Thomas Zink.

Voyage organisée par Le Comte Don de la France. Réportage par Le Marquis de Simone-Romance.

Simon Romanos



CLASSIFIED



For Sale.....

NZAC journals 1892-1984
(1892-1934 are facsimile copies)
At Pam Plumbly's rare book auction 19 June in Dunedin
see ***www.trevorplumbly.co.nz***

Proceeds from the sale will be donated by the family of the owner, the late Hallam Smith, an OSNZAC active 1933-47, towards development of the library at national headquarters.



Transceivers for sale.....

Alpine Guides is selling a limited number of Ortovox F1 and X1 avalanche transceivers. This is part of a process of buying in new units every winter. The units are fully serviceable and have been in recent use.

It is important to note that while these units are in excellent condition you need to constantly check them. We do this even with new units so it is not rocket science. Be quick as last year these sold very quickly.

Ortovox F1: \$180.00 including GST and postage per unit
Ortovox X1 Digital: \$250.00 including GST and postage per unit.

Contact:

Alpine Guides
P O Box 20
Mount Cook
03 435 1834
mtcook@alpineguides.co.nz
www.alpineguides.co.nz



For Loan.....

Loan a PLB (Personal Locator Beacon)

The club has three PLB's (emergency personal locator beacons). These are freely available to be borrowed by club members for use on club trips, instruction courses, and personal trips. If you

wish to book one email Kevin at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, or call 934 0975 (h) or 027 687 9573.

Follow the following link to obtain a hire form and for more information on how to use a PLB - http://www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz/?page_id=303.



NEW Exclusive Macpac Locations in Wellington and Petone

New Zealand's two iconic outdoor heritage brands, Macpac and Fairydown, have come together under one roof in seven locations nationwide.

While the Macpac design team continues to bring you the premium outdoor clothing and equipment that New Zealanders have trusted for generations, we have launched unique Macpac retail outlets and NEW competitive pricing that ensures quality, dependable gear is within the reach of all true outdoor enthusiasts.

Exclusive new locations of your trusted outdoor gear specialists:

Macpac – Wellington - 40 Mercer Street, CBD

Macpac – Petone - 4 Jackson Street, Petone

To receive special offers on gear and sneak product previews, sign up here:

http://www.macpac.co.nz/macpac_public/newsletter



Accommodation on Mt Ruapehu

Is your club planning to tramp, climb or ski at Mt Ruapehu or Tongariro National Park this year or in the future? The Waikato Tramping Club owns and operates a lodge on the slopes of the Whakapapa skifield which is available to members of FMC affiliated clubs. The rates are very affordable with a discounted rate for FMC club members.

To view the lodge go to www.wtc.org.nz. You will find plenty of information about the lodge and the Waikato Tramping Club.

The lodge provides self catering style accommodation and sleeps 32 in two mixed bunkrooms. There are two bathrooms with hot showers and a fully equipped kitchen for meal preparation. We provide tea, coffee, milo, sugar, milk powder, jam etc and loo paper. You will receive a full list when your booking is confirmed. Guests are required to bring all other food requirements.

Situated at grid reference 308152, the lodge is within easy walking distance (approx 15 minutes) from the car park, close to the ski slopes and the start of many great tramps and climbing areas. Visitors are welcome to join in with club activities at any time.

This is also an excellent base for summer activities on and around the mountain with summer rates applying for accommodation.

The lodge has a custodian during the ski season who can be contacted for up to date weather reports and information on ski conditions.

Bookings are essential so please visit our website at www.wtc.org.nz. For groups, please make your bookings early and for more details, call Lisa Janek on 07 854 1114.



CLUB NOTICES



Wellington Section Photo Competition 2008 – Enter Now



The annual Wellington Section photo competition is coming up soon. We're fortunate to have Shaun Barnett as judge again this time. Shaun is well known for his outdoor photography and award-winning books.

See your best photos on the big screen, get feedback from Shaun, & be in to win great prizes.

Entries close Friday 30 May, photo comp Monday 9 June

Last Year's Overall Champion
'Fox Neve', Paul Grimwood

How to take part:

1) Pick out your best slides and/or digital pics for the following categories:

*Alpine Activity

*Alpine General

*Alpine Nature

*Rockclimbing

*Photo Journalism

*Humour

2) Fill out entry form from the website (or ask for one at Bivouac) & drop it off with your photos at Bivouac, or email to wgtnphotocomp@gmail.com

If entering slides, please scan them first – all entries to be in digital format this year. Maximum of 3 entries per category per person – thanks!

For further info, contact Louise Thornley on (021) 0324537 or see the website at www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Hut closure Ball Shelter - Aoraki Area

The following hut is closed until further notice.

- Ball Shelter in the Tasman Valley is closed due to its proximity to the moraine wall.

At its present location Ball Shelter is at risk should the moraine further slump or collapse.

The Department plans to move the hut back to the toe of the hill this autumn. Recent Geotech advice is that the new location will be out of any avalanche path and should be safe for the next 20 years.

The decision to close the shelter has not been taken lightly by the Department. After aerial and ground inspections and consultation with Geotech professionals, the risk was considered high enough to close the hut.

All other huts and tracks are currently open to the public.

- Change to Radio Schedule Times

Aoraki Area Office wishes to advise hut users that from May 1st to September 30th 2008, the afternoon radio scheduled calls to huts will be at 4.45pm



ALPINE COURSES AND INSTRUCTION



Avalanche Awareness

When : Monday 9th June at 7pm

Where : Turnbull House, Bowen Street, Wellington

Avalanche Awareness courses will be held around the country starting in July. The evening will be presented by Steve Schreiber (MSC Avalanche Programme Manager), with Jamie Fitzgerald (who is the current record holder for rowing across the Atlantic, and has recently walked to the South Pole) as a guest speaker. There will be spot prizes including Avalanche equipment (thanks to Southern Approach) and vouchers to attend courses.



The Snowcraft Refresher 14/15 June

If you're wanting to brush up on skills such as crevasse rescue, avalanche transceiver use (including the NEW digital variety), snow anchors, maybe a bit of ice climbing, or just getting the feel back for using crampons and ice axe while bagging a peak or two this is an ideal opportunity.

You should all be aware that this is not an official instruction course; it is a *refresher*. Everyone must have already learned the skills that they wish to practise, and you'll need to organise your own climbing gear if you don't currently have any. Once there we will probably be dividing into at least a couple of groups, depending on what people want to do.

Based at the NZ Alpine Club Hut on Whakapapa ski field.

Contact Amanda: amandafholmes@yahoo.com.au



First Aid Course 28/29 June

This course is relevant to ANYONE who goes into the outdoors where an ambulance is not readily available; outdoor instructors, organisations as diverse as DoC, kayak clubs and outdoor centres - all needing a higher level of expertise in dealing with an emergency, make this their course of choice. For more information: www.pft.co.nz.

For either of these trips, let me know if you are interested: amandafholmes@yahoo.com.au.

If you need to do a first aid course for work, this is an ideal opportunity to get work to fund a course for them and for you!

Contact Amanda: amandafholmes@yahoo.com.au



Free climbing instruction and meets this winter

1. There are a couple of free technical climbing courses being held on Ruapehu this winter (basically the same as for last winter). These are for people who already have a grounding in using ice axes and crampons and are self sufficient on the mountain but want to get into pitched alpine climbing.

2. In August there is a climbing meet at Aoraki-Mt Cook National Park. This is to introduce climbers to big mountain climbing in winter conditions, which is something that rarely gets done in New Zealand.

Climbers need to be experienced but not necessarily climbing high grades since there will be routes from grade 1-4 to choose from.

3. Later in August is the Darrans climbing meet that is being held by Al Walker and the Southland Section of the NZAC. This is to introduce climbers to technical mixed climbing in the country's best ice playground - the Darran Mountains.

More details can easily be found on the front page of the www.mountainz.co.nz site.



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Alpine Club Members with card can climb anytime for \$8.

Monday nights show your members card and climb for \$5.



CLUB TRIPS



AND HERE ARE THE CLUB TRIPS

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, send an email to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going.

30May-2Juno8 – Mt Tapuae-o-Uenuku (2880m) – QB Weekend – Leader = Andrew Nevin – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Opening alpine snow trip for the winter season! Come climb the second highest peak in NZ outside the Mt Cook area. This was one of Hillary's early climbs back in the 1940's, except instead of doing it in 1 day like Sir Ed did we'll take 3! On Friday night we'll take the ferry and stay near the road end. Saturday will be the trip in up the Hodder River to stay at the Hodder Huts – some 66 crossings! On Sunday we'll attempt a summit via the traditional north ridge. No ropes required. Contact Andrew at 235 8098 (h) or by email at andrew.nevin@gmail.com



Mt Tapuae-o-Uenuku Summit ridge

18-20Julo8 - Ruapehu North - Te Heu Heu, Dome, and Paretetaitonga – Leader TBA – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

The plan is to drive up to Whakapapa, and climb up to Delta Corner Hut on Friday night. On Saturday we will stroll up to the crater, inspect the Dome shelter (2672m) and attempt Paratetaitonga (2751m), returning to Delta Corner for the evening. On Sunday we will return to the crater and attempt Te Heu Heu (2732m) along the main ridge, descending the skifield to the car park and home thereafter. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



North Ruapehu with the NZAC hut, Pinnacles, and Ngarauhoe

22-24Aug08 - Ruapehu South - Girdlestone and Tahurangi – Leader TBA – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Ohakune and either tent near the mountain road or stay at the backpackers. Saturday we will ascend the highest point on Ruapehu = Tahurangi peak (2797m) returning for a pub meal at the Powderhorn in the evening. On Sunday we will attempt Girdlestone (2658m), the outlying peak on the right of Tahurangi by crossing the Mangaehuehu Glacier. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.



Ruapehu Crater Lake

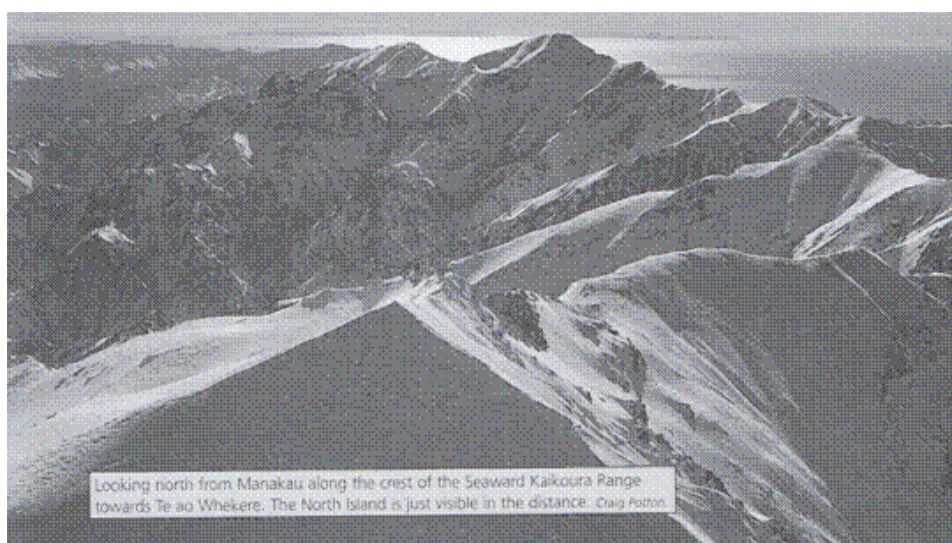
19-21Sep08 - Egmont - via Tahurangi lodge – Leader TBA – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

We will leave early on Friday afternoon (4pm) to North Egmont car park, from where we will tramp up to Tahurangi Lodge (1.5h) arriving ca. 11pm. On Saturday we will ascend Egmont (2518m) via the Lizard, returning to the lodge for the evening. On Sunday we will explore the rock walls of Warwick Castle (bring a rope for this trip) towards the eastern side before returning to the car park. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.



Mt Egmont Crater Wall 24-27Oct08 – Mt Manukau – Seaward Kaikouras – Labour Weekend - Leader James Wright – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Spring snow trip to end the northern alpine season! Come on this challenging 3 day climb in the Seaward Kaikouras. On Friday night we'll take the ferry and stay near the road end. Saturday will be the trip in up the Manaukau River followed by a climb up to a high Alpine basin where we'll tent overnight. On Sunday we'll attempt the summit via the north ridge. No ropes required. Contact James at 232 7748 or by email at james.wright@xtra.co.nz



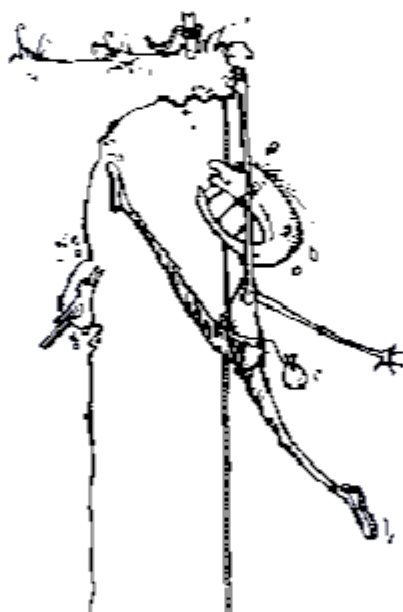
Te Ao Whakere from the summit of Mt Manakau



WELLINGTON SECTION: 2008 CONTACT LIST

Position	Name	E-mail Alias*	Phone
Chairperson	Garth London	CHAIRPERSON <i>or</i> GL	(04) 479 2984
Vice Chairperson	Jennifer Brown	JB2	027 292 0903
Secretary	Rachel Depree	SECRETARY <i>or</i> RD	N/A
Treasurer	Karen Domaneschi	TREASURER <i>or</i> KD	N/A
National Representative	Jennifer Brown and James Wright	JB2 <i>or</i> JW	N/A
	Garth London and Judy Reid	GL <i>or</i> JR	(04) 479 2984 (Garth)
Instruction: AIC	Rachael Schmidt	RS <i>or</i> AIC	N/A
Instruction: RIC	Blair Hiscoke	SPRINGROCK	N/A
National Instruction Rep	Rachael Schmidt	RS	N/A
Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	KF	N/A
Trips	Kevin Patterson	TRIPS <i>or</i> KP	N/A
	Gwen Rashbrooke	TRIPS <i>or</i> GR	N/A
Library	Derek Richardson	LIBRARY	N/A
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	N/A
Committee Members	Hayden Cox	HC	N/A
	Paul Grimwood	PG	N/A
	Pete de Joux	PD	N/A
	Blair Hiscoke	BH	N/A
	Louise Thornley	LT	N/A
	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
	Catherine Moger	CM2	N/A
Newsletter Editor	Jo Langridge	NEWSLETTER <i>or</i> JL	N/A
Webmeister	Jane Furkert	WEBMASTER <i>or</i> JF	N/A
National President	Phil Doole		N/A

* Email address is alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, eg: secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section
PO Box 1628
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